

PHONOLOGY

CHAPTER I

ORTHOGRAPHY AND PRONUNCIATION

§ 4. OE. was written in the British modified form of the Latin alphabet with the addition of þ and ƿ (= w) from the runic alphabet. Vowel length was mostly omitted in writing, but in the case of long vowels it was sometimes represented by doubling the vowel or by using the diacritic sign ´, as **huus**, **hús**, *house*. The sign ¯, placed over vowels, is used in this grammar to mark long vowels and diphthongs. The account of the pronunciation given below is only approximately accurate. It is impossible to ascertain with perfect certainty the exact pronunciation of any language in its oldest period.

A. / THE VOWELS.

§ 5. The OE. vowel-system was represented by the six elementary letters **a**, **e**, **i**, **o**, **u**, **y**, the ligatures **æ**, **œ**, and the digraphs **ea**, **eo**, **io**, and **ie**, the digraphs having the value of diphthongs. See § 6. They all had both a short and a long quantity.

a had the same sound as the **a** in NHG. **ab**, **gast**, as **dagas**, *days*; **habban**, *to have*; **hagol**, *hail*; **hara**, *hare*. **a** before nasals was probably a low-back-wide vowel like the **a** as pronounced in many Scotch dialects in such words as **ant**, **man**. In OE. it was accordingly often written **o** and may be pronounced like the **o** in NE. **not**, as **band**,

bond, *he bound* ; **land**, *lond, land* ; **lang**, *long, long* ; **mann**, *monn, man* ; **nama**, *noma, name*. See § 59.

ā had the same sound as the **a** in NE. **father**, as **ān**, *one* ; **bān**, *bone* ; **rāp**, *rope* ; **twā**, *two* ; **cnāwan**, *to know* ; **māwan**, *to mow* ; **sāwan**, *to sow*.

æ had the same sound as the **a** in NE. **hat**, as **dæg**, *day* ; **fæder**, *father* ; **fæstan**, *to fasten* ; **hæfde**, *he had* ; **mægden**, *maiden*.

ǣ had the same sound as the **ai** in NE. **air**, and the **è** in French **père**, as **dǣd**, *deed* ; **sǣd**, *seed* ; **wǣpen**, *weapon* ; **clǣne**, *clean* ; **hǣlan**, *to heal* ; **lǣdan**, *to lead* ; **sǣ**, *sea*.

e had the same sound as the **e** in NE. **west**, *end*, as **etan**, *to eat* ; **fell**, *skin* ; **helpan**, *to help* ; **segl**, *sail* ; **ende**, *end* ; **here**, *army* ; **mete**, *meat* ; **exen**, *oxen*.

ē had the same sound as the **e** in NHG. **reh**, as **hēr**, *here* ; **cwēn**, *queen* ; **fēdan**, *to feed* ; **grēne**, *green* ; **tēp**, *teeth*.

i had the same sound as the **i** in NE. **sit**, as **fisc**, *fish* ; **sittan**, *to sit* ; **ping**, *thing* ; **niman**, *to take*.

ī had the same sound as the **i** in NHG. **ihn**, and nearly the same sound as the **ee** in NE. **feed**, as **lif**, *life* ; **mīn**, *my* ; **tīd**, *time* ; **fif**, *five* ; **sīpe**, *scythe*.

o had the same sound as the **o** in NE. **not**, as **col**, *coal* ; **coren**, *chosen* ; **dohtor**, *daughter* ; **nosu**, *nose* ; **oxa**, *ox*. See **a** above.

ō had the same sound as the **o** in NHG. **bote**, as **brōpor**, *brother* ; **grōwan**, *to grow* ; **mōdor**, *mother* ; **mōna**, *moon* ; **sōna**, *soon* ; **gōs**, *goose* ; **ōper**, *other* ; **pōhte**, *he thought*.

u had the same sound as the **u** in NE. **put**, as **duru**, *door* ; **full**, *full* ; **hungor**, *hunger* ; **lufian**, *to love* ; **guma**, *man* ; **þunor**, *thunder*.

ū had the same sound as the **u** in NHG. **gut**, and nearly the same sound as the **oo** in NE. **food**, as **cū**, *cow* ; **hūs**, *house* ; **sūr**, *sour* ; **ūt**, *out* ; **mūþ**, *mouth* ; **ūs**, *us*.

æ had the same sound as the ö in NHG. *götter*, as dat. *dœhter*, to a daughter; *œle*, oil; *œxen*, oxen.

ǣ had the same sound as the ö in NHG. *schön*, as *bōec*, books; *dōema(n)*, to judge; *cwēn*, queen.

y had the same sound as the ü in NHG. *mütter*, as *brycg*, bridge; *cyning*, king; *scyld*, guilt; *þyncan*, to seem.

ȳ had the same sound as the ü in NHG. *grün*, as *brȳd*, bride; *mȳs*, mice; *wȳscan*, to wish; *ȳþ*, wave.

It is difficult to determine what was the precise pronunciation of the *a*, *e*, *o* in the second element of diphthongs. In these combinations they had the function of consonants and may be pronounced as very short unstressed *ǣ*, *ĕ*, *ō*. The first element of the diphthongs *ea*, *ēa* was a very open sound like the *æ* in OE. *fæder*, and the *a* in NE. *hat*, but the *e* in the diphthongs *eo*, *ēo* was like the *e* in NE. *bed* or like the close *é* in French *été*. In the long diphthongs each of the elements was longer than in the short diphthongs.

ea = *æ* + *ǣ*, as *eall*, all; *healdan*, to hold; *earm*, arm; *heard*, hard; *eahta*, eight; *weaxan*, to grow; *geat*, gate.

ēa = *ǣ* + *a*, as *dēaþ*, death; *hēafod*, head; *hlēapan*, to leap; *slēan*, to slay; *gēar*, year; *scēap*, sheep; *nēah*, near; *strēa*, straw.

eo = *e* + *ō*, as *meolcan*, to milk; *heorte*, heart; *steorra*, star; *sweostor*, sister; *geolo*, yellow.

ēo = *ē* + *o*, as *cēosan*, to choose; *dēop*, deep; *þeof*, thief; *sēon*, to see; *cnēo*, knee.

ie = *i* + *ĕ*, as *giest*, guest; *ieldra*, older; *ierfe*, inheritance; *hliehhan*, to laugh; *giefan*, to give; *hierde*, shepherd; *siehþ*, he sees; *cnieht*, boy.

īe = *ī* + *e*, as *hīeran*, to hear; *geliefan*, to believe; *hīehra*, higher; *cīesþ*, he chooses; *liehtan*, to give light; *nīewe*, new.

io = *i* + *ō*, as *liornian*, to learn; *mioluc*, *miolc*, milk; *miox*, manure.

io = **i** + **o**, as **liode**, *people*; **piostre**, *dark*; **sion**, *to strain*; **þion**, *to thrive*.

§ 6. From what has been said above we arrive at the following OE. vowel-system:—

Short vowels	a, æ, e, i, o, u, œ, y
Long „	ā, ǣ, ē, ī, ō, ū, œ̄, ȳ
Short diphthongs	ea, eo, ie, io
Long „	ēa, ēo, iē, iō

NOTE.—**æ** was often written **ae**, and **ę** in the oldest records. In the oldest period of the language there must have been two short **e**-sounds, viz. **e** = Germanic **e** (§ 80), and **e** = the **i**-umlaut of **æ** (§ 55), the latter probably being more open than the former, but the two sounds seem to have fallen together at an early date. Long **ī** was sometimes written **ig** finally and occasionally also medially, as **big** = **bī**, *by*; **hig** = **hī**, *they*; **big-spell** = **bīspell**, *parable*. The **ō** in words like **gōs**, *goose* (§ 61) and **mōna**, *moon* (§ 121) must originally have been an open **ō** like the **a** in NE. **all**, but it fell together with Germanic long close **ō** (§ 128) at an early period. **œ** and **œ̄**, always written **oe** in OE. manuscripts, only occur in the Anglian dialect; in WS. and Ken. they were unrounded to **ē** already in the oldest period of these dialects (§ 129). The diphthongs **ea**, **ēa** were sometimes written **æo** in the oldest records. **ie** and **iē** occur chiefly in early WS.

A diphthong may be defined as the combination of a sonantal with a consonantal vowel. It is called a falling or a rising diphthong according as the stress is upon the first or the second element. The OE. diphthongs were generally falling diphthongs, but the diphthongs, which arose from the influence of initial palatal **c**, **g**, and **sc** upon a following palatal vowel, were originally rising diphthongs which at a later period became falling diphthongs through the shifting of the stress from the second to the first element of the diphthong. See § 51.

B. THE CONSONANTS.

§ 7. The OE. consonant-system was represented by the following letters:—**b**, **c**, **d**, **f**, **g**, **h**, **k**, **l**, **m**, **n**, **p**, **r**, **s**, **t**, **þ** (**ð**), ***w**, **x**.

v (written **u**) and **z** (= **ts**) were very rarely used except occasionally in late loanwords. **c**, **cc**, **nc**, **sc**; **g**, **ng**; and **h** (except initially), **hh** were guttural or palatal according to the sound-law stated in § 309. On the vocalic liquids and nasals in OE. see § 219.

Of the above letters **b**, **d**, **m**, **n**, **p**, **t** had the same sound-values as in Modern English. The remaining consonants require special attention.

c. Guttural **c**, sometimes written **k** in the oldest records, was pronounced nearly like the **c** in NE. *could*. Palatal **c** (often written **ce** before a following guttural vowel) was pronounced nearly like the **k** in NE. *kid*. In the OE. runic alphabet the two **k**-sounds had separate characters. Some scholars assume that palatal **c** and **sc** were pronounced like the **ch** and **sh** in NE. *church*; *ship*, *fish*. Examples of guttural **c** are: *bucca*, *he-goat*; *cēlan*, *to cool*; *cnēo*, *knee*; *sprecan*, *to speak*; *cyssan*, *to kiss*; *bōc*, *book*; *weorc*, *work*; *drincan*, *to drink*; *þancian*, *to thank*; and of palatal **c**: *cēosan*, *to choose*; *cinn*, *chin*; *cīese*, *cheese*; *bēc*, *books*; *crycc*, *crutch*; *benc*, *bench*; *þenc(e)an*, *to think*; of **sc**: *sceal*, *shall*; *scēap*, *sheep*; *scōh*, *shoe*; *wascan*, *to wash*; *fisc*, *fish*.

f. Initially, finally, and medially before voiceless consonants, also when doubled, **f** was a voiceless spirant like the **f** in NE. *fit*, *shaft*, as *fæder*, *father*; *fōt*, *foot*; *ceaf*, *chaff*; *hrōf*, *roof*; *geaf*, *he gave*; *sceaft*, *shaft*; *pyffan*, *to puff*. Medially between voiced sounds it was a voiced spirant (often written **b** in the oldest records) like the **v** in NE. *vine*, *five*, as *giefan*, *to give*; *hafap*, *he has*; *seofon*, *seven*; *wulfas*, *wolves*; *hræfn*, *raven*; *lifde*, *he lived*.

g was used to represent several different sounds: (a) a guttural and a palatal explosive; (b) a guttural and a palatal spirant which had separate characters in the OE. runic alphabet. The palatal explosive and the palatal spirant

were often written **ge** before a following guttural vowel with **e** to indicate the palatal nature of the **g**.

Before guttural vowels initial **g** was pronounced like the **g** in NE. **good**, but in the oldest OE. like the **g** in NHG. **sagen** (§ 314), as **gāst**, *spirit*; **god**, *God*; **gold**, *gold*. Before palatal vowels initial **g** was a palatal spirant nearly like the **j** in NHG. **jahr** and the **y** in NE. **ye**, **you**, as **geaf**, *he gave*; **giefan**, *to give*; **giest**, *yeast*; **geoc**, *yoke*.

Medial **gg** was always a guttural explosive like the **g** in NE. **good**, as **dogga**, *dog*; **frogga**, *frog*; **stagga**, *stag*. Medial and final **cg** was a palatal explosive nearly like the **g** in NE. **get**, as **lecg(e)an**, *to lay*; **secg(e)an**, *to say*; **brycg**, *bridge*; **wecg**, *wedge*. The **g** in medial and final **ng** was a guttural or a palatal explosive, the former being nearly like the **g** in NE. **longer**, as **sungon**, *they sang*; **hungor**, *hunger*; **lang**, *long*; and the latter nearly like the **g** in NE. **finger**, as **lengra**, *longer*; **streng**, *string*; **þing**, *thing*.

Medial intervocalic **g** was a guttural or a palatal spirant, the former being nearly like the **g** in NHG. **sagen**, as **boga**, *bow*; **fugol**, *bird*; **lagu**, *law*; and the latter nearly like the **g** in NHG. **siegen**, as **bīeg(e)an**, *to bend*; **fæger**, *fair*; **hyge**, *mind*.

NOTE.—1. Some scholars assume that palatal **cg** and **ng** were pronounced **dž** and **ndž** where **dž** = the **j** in NE. **just**.

2. **g** is generally used for **g** in OE. manuscripts and printed texts, and often also in grammars. In this grammar **g** is only used to represent the prim. Germanic voiced spirant (§ 229, Note 5).

h. Initial **h** (except in the combination **hw**) was an aspirate like the **h** in NE. **hand**, as **habban**, *to have*; **heard**, *hard*; **hūs**, *house*; **hlūd**, *loud*. Initial **hw** was pronounced **xw** like the **wh** in many Scotch dialects, as **hwā**, *who?*; **hwæte**, *wheat*. In all other positions **h**, including **hh**, was a guttural or a palatal spirant, the former being like the **ch** in NHG. **nacht**, **noch**, as **dohtor**, *daughter*;

eahta, *eight*; **tiohhian**, *to think, consider*; **sulh**, *plough*; **feorh**, *life*; **dāh**, *dough*; **troh**, *trough*; and the latter like the **ch** in NHG. **nicht**, *ich*, as **flyht**, *flight*; **siehp**, *he sees*; **nēah**, *near*; **hliehhan**, *to laugh*. In the oldest records final **h** was sometimes written **ch**, as **elch** = **eolh**, *elk*; **salch** = **sealh**, *willow*.

k was sometimes used to express the guttural **c** (see above), as **kynn**, *race, generation*; **kyning**, *king*; **knēo**, *knee*. See § 319.

1. In Northumbrian and the greater portion of the Mercian district, **l** was pronounced like the **l** in NHG. and in standard NE., but in West Saxon, Kentish, and parts of the southern portion of Mercia, it was a reverted sound formed by the under surface of the tip of the tongue being turned to the hard palate which imparted to the sound a kind of guttural quality. This explains why breaking (§§ 49, 63) took place in WS. and Ken. before **l** + consonant, but not in Anglian. The reverted **l** is still preserved in the dialects of the southern and south-western counties. Examples are: **lædan**, *to lead*; **folc**, *folk*; **fugol**, *bird*; **eall**, *all*; **healdan**, *to hold*; **meolcan**, *to milk*.

r was trilled in all positions as in Modern Scotch, as **rīdan**, *to ride*; **duru**, *door*; **word**, *word*; **fæder**, *father*. In West Saxon, Kentish, and parts of the southern portion of Mercia, it was reverted like **l** (see above), which accounts for breaking taking place before **r** + consonant more regularly in WS. and Ken. than in Anglian, as **earm**, *arm*; **heard**, *hard*; **eorpe**, *earth*; **liornian**, *to learn*.

s. Initially, finally, medially before voiceless consonants, and when doubled, **s** was a voiceless spirant like the **s** in NE. *sit*, as **sealt**, *salt*; **sunu**, *son*; **standan**, *to stand*; **sweos-tor**, *sister*; **hūs**, *house*; **īs**, *ice*; **cyssan**, *to kiss*. Medially between voiced sounds, it was a voiced spirant like the **s** in NE. *rise*, as **bōsm**, *bosom*; **cēosan**, *to choose*; **nosu**, *nose*; **ōsle**, *ousel*.

þ. Initially, medially when doubled, and finally **þ** was a voiceless spirant like the **th** in NE. *thin*, as **þencan**, *to think*; **þeof**, *thief*; **moþpe**, *moth*; **bæþ**, *bath*; **mūþ**, *mouth*. Medially between voiced sounds, it was a voiced spirant like the **th** in NE. *then*, as **baþian**, *to bathe*; **brōþor**, *brother*; **eorþe**, *earth*; **fæþm**, *fathom*.

Initial **þ** was written **th** until about 900 in imitation of Latin. Afterwards it was written **ð**, and **þ** (borrowed from the runic alphabet). And the voiced spirant was often written **d** in imitation of the contemporary Latin pronunciation.

w does not occur in OE. manuscripts, but was represented by **uu**, **u** until about the year 900, later by **ƿ** borrowed from the runic alphabet. It had the same sound-value as the **w** in NE. *wet*, as **wæter**, *water*; **sweltan**, *to die*; **wlanc**, *proud*; **sāwol**, *soul*.

x was pronounced like the **x** in NE. *six*, as **rīxian**, *to rule*; **siex**, *six*; **weaxan**, *to grow*; **āxian**, *to ask*.

§ 8. From what has been said above we arrive at the following OE. consonant-system:—

	LABIAL.	INTER-DENTAL.	DENTAL.	GUT-TURAL.	PALATAL.
<i>Explosives</i> {	Voiceless p, pp		t, tt	c, cc	c, cc
	Voiced b, bb		d, dd	g, gg	g, cg
<i>Spirants</i> {	Voiceless f, ff	þ, þþ	s, ss	h, hh	h, hh
	Voiced f	þ	s	g	g
<i>Nasals</i>	m, mm		n, nn	n	n
<i>Liquids</i>			l, ll ; r, rr		
<i>Semi-vowel</i>	w				

To these must be added the aspirate **h**, and **x**. The double consonants were pronounced long as in Modern Italian and Swedish, thus **habban** = **hab-ban**, *to have*; **swimman** = **swim-man**, *to swim*, see §§ 258–9. From the above table it will be seen that the OE. alphabet was very defective, insomuch as each of the letters **c, f, g, h, n, s**, and **þ** was used to represent two or more sounds.

STRESS (ACCENT).

§ 9. All the Indo-Germanic languages have partly pitch (musical) and partly stress accent, but one or other of the two systems of accentuation always predominates in each language, thus in Sanskrit and Old Greek the accent was predominantly pitch, whereas in the oldest periods of the Italic dialects, and the Keltic and Germanic languages, the accent was predominantly stress. This difference in the system of accentuation is clearly seen in Old Greek and the old Germanic languages by the preservation of the vowels of unaccented syllables in the former and the weakening or loss of them in the latter. In the early period of the parent Indg. language, the stress accent must have been more predominant than the pitch accent, because it is only upon this assumption that we are able to account for the origin of the vowels *ĩ, ũ, ə* (§ 16, Note 1), the liquid and nasal sonants (§§ 34–7), and the loss of vowel often accompanied by a loss of syllable, as in Greek gen. *πα-τρ-ός* beside acc. *πα-τέρ-α* ; *πέτ-ομαι* beside *ἐ-πτ-όμην* ; Gothic gen. pl. *aúhs-nē* beside acc. **aúhsa-ns*. It is now a generally accepted theory that at a later period of the parent language the system of accentuation became predominantly pitch, which was preserved in Sanskrit and Old Greek, but which must have become predominantly stress again in prim. Germanic some time prior to the operation of Verner's law (§ 238).

The quality of the accent in the parent language was partly 'broken' (acute) and partly 'slurred' (circumflex). This distinction in the quality of the accent was preserved in prim. Germanic in final syllables containing a long vowel, as is seen by the difference in the development of the final long vowels in historic times according as they originally had the 'broken' or 'slurred' accent (§ 217).

In the parent language the chief accent of a word did

not always fall upon the same syllable of a word, but was free or movable as in Sanskrit and Greek, cp. e. g. Gr. nom. πατήρ, *father*, voc. πάτερ, acc. πατέρα; Skr. émi, *I go*, pl. imás, *we go*. This free accent was still preserved in prim. Germanic at the time when Verner's law operated, whereby the voiceless spirants became voiced when the vowel immediately preceding them did not bear the chief accent of the word (§ 238). At a later period of the prim. Germanic language, the chief accent of a word became confined to the root- or stem-syllable. This confining of the chief accent to the root-syllable was the cause of the great weakening—and eventual loss—which the vowels underwent in unaccented syllables in the prehistoric period of the individual Germanic languages (§§ 212–7). And the extent to which the weakening of unaccented syllables has been carried in some of the Modern Germanic dialects is well illustrated by such sentences as, *as et it mōæn*, *I shall have it in the morning*; *ast ə dunt if id kud*, *I should have done it if I had been able* (West Yorks.).

§ 10. The rule for the accentuation of uncompounded words is the same in Old English as in the oldest period of the other Germanic languages, viz. the chief stress fell upon the stem-syllable and always remained there even when suffixes and inflexional endings followed it, as *beran*, *to bear*; *dagas*, *days*. *grēting*, *greeting*; *hǣlnes*, *salvation*; *hāriht*, *hairy*; *handlung*, *handling*; *mistig*, *misty*. *hlēapettan*, *to leap*; *ierringa*, *angrily*; *lēofosta*, *dearest*. *hēafodu*, *heads*; *lænere*, *lender*; *sealfian*, *to anoint*; *wundrode*, *he wondered*. *berende*, *bearing*; *cyningas*, *kings*; *grimettan*, *to rage*. *gædeling*, *companion*; *heofonisc*, *heofonlic*, *heavenly*. *æpele*, *noble*; *hetele*, *hostile*; *macode*, *he made*; *nerede*, *he saved*. *æpelingas*, *noblemen*; *fultumian*, *to help*; *huntigestre*, *huntress*; *maþelode*, *he spoke*. The position of the secondary stress in trisyllabic and polysyllabic words

fluctuated in OE., and with the present state of our knowledge of the subject it is impossible to formulate any hard and fast rules concerning it.

In compound words it is necessary to distinguish between compounds whose second element is a noun or an adjective, and those whose second element is a verb. In the former case the first element had the chief accent in the parent Indg. language; in the latter case the first element had or had not the chief accent according to the position of the verb in the sentence. But already in prim. Germanic the second element of compound verbs nearly always had the chief accent; a change which was mostly brought about by the compound and simple verb existing side by side. This accounts for the difference in the accentuation of such pairs as *ándgiet*, *intelligence* : *ongíetan*, *to understand*; *ándsaca*, *adversary* : *onsácan*, *to deny*; *bígang*, *practice* : *begángen*, *to practise*; *órþanc*, *device* : *āþéncan*, *to devise*; *úþgegne*, *fugitive* : *oþgángen*, *to escape*; *wíþersaca*, *opponent* : *wiþsácan*, *to oppose*.

§ 11. As has been stated above, compound words, whose second element is a noun or an adjective, had originally the chief stress on the first syllable. This simple rule was preserved in OE., as *ācbēam*, *oak-tree*; *æftergield*, *additional payment*; *brýdguma*, *bridegroom*; *cornhūs*, *granary*; *dēapstede*, *death-place*; *fēowergield*, *fourfold payment*; *frēomæg*, *free kinsman*; *gēardagas*, *days of yore*; *godbearn*, *godchild*; *lārhūs*, *school*. *æfterboren*, *posthumous*; *æpelcund*, *of noble origin*; *ārfæst*, *virtuous*; *brynehāt*, *burning hot*; *gearowyrdig*, *eloquent*; *isengræg*, *iron-grey*; *mōdwlanc*, *proud*; *wordsnotor*, *eloquent*. Nouns like *āliefednes*, *permission*, *onfángennes*, *reception*, *ongíetennes*, *understanding*, *ongínn*, *beginning*, &c., are no exception to the rule, because such nouns were formed direct from the corresponding verbs: pp. *āliefed*, *onfángen*, *ongíeten*, inf. *ongínnan*.

§ 12. Already in the oldest period of the language many nouns and adjectives were formed from verbs containing an inseparable particle, and accordingly had the chief stress on the second element, as **bebod**, *command*; **bebyrignes**, *burying*; **bedelfing**, *digging round*; **begang** beside **bígeng**, *practice*; **behāt**, *promise*; **behēfe**, *suitable*; **belāf**, *remainder*; **belimp**, *occurrence*; **forbod**, *prohibition*; **for-gietol**, *forgetful*; **forhæfednes**, *temperance*; **forlor**, **forlorennes**, *destruction*; but **fórwyrd**, *ruin*. In like manner the prefix **ge-** was already unaccented in the oldest period of the language—probably partly also in prim. Germanic—and therefore words compounded with it had the chief stress on the second element, as **gebann**, *decree*; **gebed**, *prayer*; **gebrōpor**, *brethren*; **gefeoht**, *fight*; **gefēra**, *companion*; **gesceaft**, *creation*; **gepeaht**, *counsel, thought*; **gewider**, *bad weather, storm*; **ge-æpele**, *congenial*; **gecoren**, *chosen*; **gecynde**, *innate, natural*; **gedēfe**, *befitting*; **gelic**, *alike*; **gemāne**, *common*; **gemyndig**, *mindful*; **gesund**, *healthy*; **gefyrrn**, *long ago*.

§ 13. In compound nouns the chief secondary stress was upon that syllable of the second element which would have the chief stress if it were used alone, as **brýdgūma**, *bridegroom*; **fēowergield**, *fourfold payment*; **gēarowýrdig**, *eloquent*. For further examples, see above. But compounds which were no longer felt as such did not have a strong secondary stress upon the second element, as **ēorod** from **eoh** + **rād**, *troop of cavalry*; **hlāford** from **hlāf** + **weard**, *lord*; **weorud**, **werod** from **wer** + **rād**, *multitude, army*.

§ 14. In the oldest period of the language, the compound verbs had the chief stress upon the second or first element according as the first element was inseparable or separable, as **becúman**, *to become*; **behéaldan**, *to behold*; and similarly **gebæran**, *to behave*; **gehātan**, *to name*; **forbēodan**, *to forbid*; **forgiefan**, *to forgive*; **geondsēon**, *to survey*; **geondpencan**, *to consider*; **oþberstan**, *to break away*; **oþfeallan**,

to fall off; *tōberstan*, to burst asunder; *tōdælan*, to divide. *ætiēwan*, to exhibit; *ætníman*, to deprive; and similarly *oferswīpan*, to overcome; *oferweorpan*, to overthrow; *underberan*, to support; *underniman*, to comprehend; *þurh-þýrelian*, to pierce through; *þurhwunian*, to abide continuously; *wipfōn*, to grasp at; *wipmetan*, to compare; *ymbbindan*, to bind round; *ymbhweorfan*, to revolve. Verbs like *ándswarian*, to answer, *ándwyrðan*, to answer, *fúltumian*, to support, *órettan*, to fight, are no exception to the rule, because such verbs were formed direct from the nouns: *ándswaru*, *ándwyrde*, *fúltum*, *óret*. Examples of separable verbs are: *æftersprecan*, to claim; *æfterfolgian*, to pursue; *bístandan*, to support; *bílibban*, to live by; and similarly *eftcierran*, to turn back; *eftflōwan*, to flow back; *foregangan*, to precede; *forescēawian*, to foresee; *ūpræran*, to raise up; *ūpiernan*, to run up; *incuman*, to come in; *midwunian*, to live together; *ongēanfealdan*, to fold back; *tōdōn*, to put to; *ūtdrīfan*, to drive out; *ūtlōwan*, to flow out.

§ 15. In compound adverbs the first element had the chief or secondary stress according as it was the more or less important element of the compound, as *éal(1)mæst*, almost; *éalnæg* from *ealne* + *weg*, always; *éalswā*, quite so; but *onwég*, away; *tōgædere*, together; *þærinne*, therein.

CHAPTER II

THE PRIMITIVE GERMANIC EQUIVALENTS
OF THE INDO-GERMANIC VOWEL-SOUNDS

§ 16. The parent Indo-Germanic language had the following vowel-system :—

Short vowels	a, e, i, o, u, ə
Long „	ā, ē, ī, ō, ū
Short diphthongs	ai, ei, oi, au, eu, ou
Long „	āi, ēi, ōi, āu, ēu, ōu
Short vocalic	l, m, n, r

NOTE.—1. The short vowels *i, u, ə*, the long vowels *ī, ū*, and vocalic *l, m, n, r* occurred originally only in syllables which did not bear the principal accent of the word.

The short vowels *i, u*, and vocalic *l, m, n, r* arose from the loss of *e* in the strong forms *ei, eu, el, em, en, er*, which was caused by the principal accent having been shifted to some other syllable in the word.

ə, the quality of which cannot be precisely defined, arose from the weakening of an original *ā, ē*, or *ō*, caused by the loss of accent. It is generally pronounced like the final vowel in German *Gabe*.

ī and *ū* were contractions of weak diphthongs which arose from the strong forms *eiā, āi, ēi, ōi* ; *euā, āu, ēu, ōu* through the loss of accent. The *e* in *eiā, euā* had disappeared before the contraction took place. See § 9.

2. The long diphthongs *āi, ēi, &c.*, were of rare occurrence in the parent language, and their history in the prehistoric period of the various branches of the Indo-Germanic languages, except when final, is still somewhat obscure. In stem-syllables they were generally either shortened to *ai, ei, &c.*, or the second element (*i, u*) disappeared. In final syllables they were generally shortened to *ai, ei, &c.* In this book no further account will be taken of the Indg. long diphthongs in stem-syllables.

For their treatment in final syllables in Primitive Germanic, see § 217.

3. Upon theoretical grounds it is generally assumed that the parent language contained long vocalic **l, m, n, r**. But their history in the various Indg. languages is still uncertain. In any case they were of very rare occurrence, and are therefore left out of consideration in this book.

§ 17. **a** (Lat. **a**, Gr. **α**) remained, as Lat. **ager**, Gr. **ἄγρός**, Goth. **akrs**, O.Icel. **akr**, OS. **akkar**, OHG. **ackar**, OE. **æcer**, *field, acre*; Gr. **ἄλς**, Lat. gen. **salis**, Goth. O.Icel. **salt**, OHG. **salz**, OE. **sealt** (§ 64), *salt*; Lat. **aqua**, Goth. **alva**, OS. OHG. **aha**, OE. **ēa** from **eahu*, older **ahu* (§ 70), *water, river*.

§ 18. **e** (Lat. **e**, Gr. **ε**) remained, as Lat. **ferō**, Gr. **φέρω**, *I bear*, O.Icel. **bera**, OS. OHG. OE. **beran**, *to bear*; Lat. **edō**, Gr. **ἔδομαι**, *I eat*, O.Icel. **eta**, OHG. **ezzan**, OS. OE. **etan**, *to eat*; Lat. **pellis**, Gr. **πέλλα**, OS. OHG. **fel**, OE. **fell**, *skin, hide*.

§ 19. **i** (Lat. **i**, Gr. **ι**) remained, as Gr. Hom. **ῖδμεν**, Goth. **witum**, O.Icel. **vitum**, OS. **witun**, OHG. **wizzum**, OE. **witon**, *we know*, cp. Lat. **vidēre**, *to see*; Lat. **piscis**, Goth. **fisks**, O.Icel. **fiskr**, OS. **fisk**, OHG. OE. **fisc**, *fish*; Lat. **vidua** (adj. fem.), *bereft of, deprived of*, Goth. **widuwō**, OS. **widowa**, OHG. **wituwa**, OE. **widewe**, *widow*.

§ 20. **o** (Lat. **o**, Gr. **ο**) became **a** in stem-syllables, as Lat. **octō**, Gr. **ὀκτώ**, Goth. **ahtáu**, OS. OHG. **ahto**, OE. **eahta** (§ 68), *eight*; Lat. **hostis**, *stranger, enemy*, Goth. **gasts**, OS. OHG. **gast**, OE. **giest** (§ 73), *guest*; Lat. **quod**, Goth. **hva**, O.Icel. **hvat**, OS. **hwat**, OHG. **hwaz**, OE. **hwæt**, *what*.

§ 21. **u** (Lat. **u**, Gr. **υ**) remained, as Gr. **κυνός** (gen. sing.), Goth. **hunds**, O.Icel. **hundr**, OHG. **hunt**, OS. OE. **hund**, *dog, hound*; Gr. **θύρᾱ**, OS. **duri**, OHG. **turi**, OE. **duru**, *door*; Skr. **bu-budhimá**, *we watched*, Gr. **πέ-πυσται**, *he has inquired*, Goth. **budum**, O.Icel. **buðum**, OS. **budun**, OHG. **butum**, OE. **budon**, *we announced, offered*.

§ 22. *ə* became *a* in all the Indo-Germanic languages, except in the Aryan branch, where it became *i*, as Lat. *pater*, Gr. πατήρ, O.Ir. *athir*, Goth. *fadar*, O.Icel. *faðir*, OS. *fader*, OHG. *fater*, OE. *fæder*, *father*, Skr. *pitár-* (from **pəté-*), *father*; Lat. *status*, Gr. στατός, Skr. *sthitás*, *standing*, Goth. *staps*, O.Icel. *staðr*, OS. *stad*, OHG. *stat*, OE. *stede*, prim. Germanic **stadiz*, *place*.

§ 23. *ā* (Lat. *ā*, Gr. Doric *ā*, Attic, Ionic *η*) became *ō*, as Lat. *māter*, Gr. Dor. μᾶτηρ, O.Icel. *mōðir*, OS. *mōdar*, OHG. *muoter*, OE. *mōdor*, *mother*; Gr. Dor. φράτηρ, *member of a clan*, Lat. *frāter*, Goth. *brōþar*, O.Icel. *brōðir*, OS. *brōthar*, OHG. *bruoder*, OE. *brōþor*, *brother*; Lat. *fāgus*, *beech*, Gr. Dor. φᾶγός, *a kind of oak*, Goth. *bōka*, *letter of the alphabet*, O.Icel. OS. *bōk*, *book*, OE. *bōc-trēow*, *beech-tree*.

§ 24. *ē* (Lat. *ē*, Gr. *η*) remained, but it is generally written *æ* (= Goth. *ē*, O.Icel. OS. OHG. *ā*, OE. *æ*) in works on Germanic philology, as Lat. *ēdimus*, Goth. *ētum*, O.Icel. *ātum*, OS. *ātun*, OHG. *āzum*, OE. *æton*, *we ate*; Lat. *mēnsis*, Gr. μήν, *month*, Goth. *mēna*, O.Icel. *māne*, OS. OHG. *māno*, OE. *mōna* (§ 121), *moon*; Goth. *ga-dēps*, O.Icel. *dāð*, OS. *dād*, OHG. *tāt*, OE. *dæd*, *deed*, related to Gr. θή-σω, *I shall place*.

§ 25. *ī* (Lat. *ī*, Gr. *ι*) remained, as Lat. *su-īnus* (adj.), *belonging to a pig*, Goth. *swein*, O.Icel. *svīn*, OS. OHG. OE. *swīn*, *swine*, *pig*; Lat. *sīmus*, OS. *sīn*, OHG. *sīm*, OE. *sī-en*, *we may be*.

§ 26. *ō* (Lat. *ō*, Gr. *ω*) remained, as Gr. πλωτός, *swimming*, Goth. *flōdus*, O.Icel. *flōð*, OHG. *fluot*, OS. OE. *flōd*, *flood*, *tide*, cp. Lat. *plōrāre*, *to weep aloud*; Gr. Dor. πώς, Goth. *fōtus*, O.Icel. *fōtr*, OHG. *fuoz*, OS. OE. *fōt*, *foot*; Goth. *dōms*, O.Icel. *dōmr*, OHG. *tuom*, OS. OE. *dōm*, *judgment*, *sentence*, related to Gr. θωμός, *heap*.

§ 27. *ū* (Lat. *ū*, Gr. *υ*) remained, as Lat. *mūs*, Gr. μῦς, O.Icel. OHG. OE. *mūs*, *mouse*; Lat. *sūs*, Gr. ὕς, OHG.

OE. *sū*, *sow*, *pig*; Goth. *fūls*, O.Icel. *fūll*, OHG. OE. *fūl*, *foul*, related to Lat. *pūteō*, *I smell bad*, Gr. *πύθω*, *I make to rot*.

§ 28. *ai* (Lat. *ae* (*ē*), Gr. *αι*, Goth. *ái*, O.Icel. *ei*, OS. *ē*, OHG. *ei* (*ē*), OE. *ā*) remained, as Lat. *aedēs*, *sanctuary*, originally *fire-place, hearth*, Gr. *αἶθω*, *I burn*, OHG. *eit*, OE. *ād*, *funeral pile, ignis, rokus*; Lat. *aes*, Goth. *áiz*, O.Icel. *eir*, OHG. *ēr*, OE. *ār*, *brass, metal, money*; Lat. *caedō*, *I hew, cut down*, Goth. *skáidan*, OS. *skēdan*, *skēðan*, OHG. *sceidan*, OE. *scādan*, *sceādan* (§ 133, Note 2), *to divide, sever*.

§ 29. *ei* (Lat. *ī* (older *ei*), Gr. *ει*) became *ī*, as Gr. *στέιχω*, *I go*, Goth. *steigan* (*ei* = *ī*), O.Icel. *stiga*, OS. OHG. OE. *stigan*, *to ascend*; Gr. *λείπω*, *I leave*, Goth. *leihvan*, OS. OHG. *lihan*, OE. *lēon* from **liohan*, older **lihan* (§ 127), *to lend*; Lat. *dīcō*, *I say, tell*, Gr. *δείκνυμι*, *I show*, Goth. *ga-teihan*, *to tell, declare*, OS. *af-tihan*, *to deny*, OHG. *zīhan*, OE. *tēon*, *to accuse* (§ 127).

§ 30. *oi* (O.Lat. *oi* (later *ū*), Gr. *ου*) became *ai* (cp. § 20), as Gr. *οἶδε*, Goth. *wáit*, O.Icel. *veit*, OS. *wēt*, OHG. *weiz*, OE. *wāt*, *he knows*; O.Lat. *oinos*, later *ūnus*, Goth. *áins*, O.Icel. *einn*, OS. *ēn*, OHG. *ein*, OE. *ān*, *one*, cp. Gr. *οἷνῃ*, *the one on dice*; Gr. *πέ-πειθε*, *he trusts*, Goth. *báip*, O.Icel. *beið*, OS. *bēd*, OHG. *beit*, OE. *bād*, *he waited for*.

§ 31. *au* (Lat. *au*, Gr. *αυ*, Goth. *áu*, O.Icel. *au*, OS. *ō*, OHG. *ou* (*ō*), OE. *ēa*) remained, as Lat. *auris*, Goth. *áusō*, OS. OHG. *ōra*, OE. *ēare*, *ear*; Lat. *augeō*, Gr. *αὐξάνω*, *I increase*, Goth. *áukan*, O.Icel. *auka*, OS. *ōkian*, OHG. *ouhhōn*, OE. *ēacian*, *to add, increase*.

§ 32. *eu* (Lat. *ou* (later *ū*), Gr. *ευ*, Goth. *iu*, O.Icel. *jō* (*jū*), OS. OHG. *io*, OE. *ēo*) remained, as Gr. *γεύω*, *I give a taste of*, Goth. *kiusan*, O.Icel. *kjōsa*, OS. OHG. *kiosan*, OE. *cēosan*, *to test, choose*; Gr. *πεύθομαι*, *I inquire*, Goth. *ana-biudan*, *to order, command*, O.Icel. *bjōða*, OS. *biodan*, OHG. *biotan*, OE. *bēodan*, *to offer*; Lat. *doucō* (*dūcō*),

I lead, Goth. **tiuhan**, OS. **tiohan**, OHG. **ziohan**, OE. **tēon** (§ 139), *to lead, draw*. See § 44.

§ 33. **ou** (Lat. **ou** (later **ū**), Gr. **ου**) became **au** (cp. § 20), as prim. Indg. ***roudhos**, Goth. **ráuþs**, O.Icel. **rauðr**, OS. **rōd**, OHG. **rōt**, OE. **rēad**, *red*, cp. Lat. **rūfus**, *red*; prim. Indg. ***bhe-bhoudhe**, *has waked*, Goth. **báuþ**, O.Icel. **bauð**, OS. **bōd**, OHG. **bōt**, OE. **bēad**, *has offered*.

§ 34. **m** (Lat. **em**, Gr. **α, αμ**) became **um**, as Gr. **ἀμο-** (in **ἀμόθεν**, *from some place or other*), Goth. **sums**, O.Icel. **sumr**, OS. OHG. OE. **sum**, *some one*; Gr. **ἐκτόν**, Lat. **centum** (with **n** from **m** by assimilation, and similarly in the Germanic languages), Goth. OE. OS. **hund**, OHG. **hunt**, *hundred*, all from a prim. form ***kmtóm**.

§ 35. **n** (Lat. **en**, Gr. **α, αν**) became **un**, as Lat. **com-mentus** (pp.), *invented, devised*, Gr. **αὐτό-ματος**, *acting of one's own will*, Goth. **ga-munds**, OHG. **gi-munt**, OE. **ge-mynd** (§ 112), *remembrance*, prim. form ***mntós** (pp.) from root **men-**, *think*; OS. **wundar**, OHG. **wuntar**, OE. **wundor**, *wonder*, cp. Gr. **ἀθρέω** from ***φᾱθρέω**, *I gaze at*.

§ 36. **r** (Lat. **or**, Gr. **αρ, ρα**) became **ur, ru**, as OHG. **gi-turrun**, OE. **durron**, *we dare*, cp. Gr. **θαρσύς** (**θρασύς**), *bold*, **θαρσέω**, *I am of good courage*; dat. pl. Gr. **πατράσι**, Goth. **fadrum**, OHG. **faterum**, OE. **fæd(e)rum**, *to fathers*; Lat. **porca**, *the ridge between two furrows*, OHG. **furuh**, OE. **furh**, *furrow*.

§ 37. **l** (Lat. **ol**, Gr. **αλ, λα**) became **ul, lu**, as Goth. **fulls**, O.Icel. **fullr**, OHG. **vol**, OS. OE. **full**, prim. form ***plnós**, *full*; Goth. **wulfs**, O.Icel. **ulfr**, OHG. **wolf**, OS. OE. **wulf**, prim. form ***wlqos**, *wolf*.

NOTE.—If we summarize the vowel-changes which have been stated in this chapter, it will be seen that the following vowel-sounds fell together:—**a, o**, and **ə**; original **u** and the **u** which arose from Indg. vocalic **l, m, n, r**; **ī** and **ei**; **ā** and **ō**; **ai** and **oi**; **au** and **ou**.

CHAPTER III

THE PRIMITIVE GERMANIC VOWEL-SYSTEM

§ 38. From what has been said in §§ 17-37, we arrive at the following vowel-system for the prim. Germanic language:—

Short vowels	a, e, i, u
Long „	ā, ē, ī, ō, ū
Diphthongs	ai, au, eu

NOTE.—*ā* was an open *e*-sound like OE. *æ*. *ē* was a close sound like the *e* in NHG. *reh*. The origin of this vowel has not yet been satisfactorily explained. It is important to remember that it is never the equivalent of Indo-Germanic *ē* (§ 24) which appears as *ā* in prim. Germanic. See §§ 119, 125.

§ 39. This system underwent several modifications during the prim. Germanic period, i.e. before the parent language became differentiated into the various separate Germanic languages. The most important of these changes were:—

§ 40. *a* + *ŋx* became *āx*, as Goth. OS. OHG. *fāhan*, O.Icel. *fā*, OE. *fōn* (§ 139), from **faŋxanan*, *to catch, seize*, cp. Lat. *pangō*, *I fasten*; Goth. *pāhta*, OS. *thāhta*, OHG. *dāhta*, OE. *pōhte* (inf. *pencan*), from older **paŋxta*, **paŋxtō*, *I thought*, cp. O.Lat. *tongeō*, *I know*. Every prim. Germanic *ā* in accented syllables was of this origin. Cp. § 23.

NOTE.—The *ā* in the above and similar examples was still a nasalized vowel in prim. Germanic, as is seen by its development to *ō* in OE. The *ī* (§ 41) and *ū* (§ 43) were also nasalized vowels in prim. Germanic.

§ 41. *e* became *i* under the following circumstances:—

1. Before a nasal + consonant, as Goth. OS. OE.

bindan, O.Icel. **binda**, OHG. **bintan**, *to bind*, cp. Lat. **of-fendimentum**, *chin-cloth*, **of-fendix**, *knot, band*, Gr. **πενθερός**, *father-in-law*; Lat. **ventus**, Goth. **winds**, O.Icel. **vindr**, OHG. **wint**, OS. OE. **wind**, *wind*; Gr. **πέντε**, Goth. **fimf**, O.Icel. **fim(m)**, OHG. **fimf**, **finf**, OE. **fif** (§ 97), *five*. This explains why OE. **bindan**, *to bind*, and **helpan**, *to help*, belong to the same ablaut-series. See § 226.

This **i** became **ī** under the same conditions as those by which **a** became **ā** (§ 40), as Goth. **þeiħan**, OS. **thīħan**, OHG. **dīħan**, OE. **þēon** (§ 127), from ***þiŋxanan**, older ***þeŋxanan**, *to thrive*; and similarly OHG. **sīħan**, OE. **sēon**, *to strain*; OHG. **fihala**, OE. **fēol**, *file*; OHG. **dīhsala**, OE. **þixl** (**þisl**), *wagon-pole, shaft*.

2. When followed by an **i**, **ī**, or **j** in the next syllable, as Goth. OS. OHG. **ist**, OE. **is**, from ***isti**, older ***esti** = Gr. **ἔστι**, *is*; OHG. **irdīn**, *earthen*, beside **erda**, *earth*; Goth. **midjis**, O.Icel. **miðr**, OS. **middi**, OHG. **mitti**, OE. **midd**, Lat. **medius**, from an original form ***medhjos**, *middle*; OS. **birid**, OHG. **birit**, *he bears*, from an original form ***bhéreti**, through the intermediate stages ***bérédi**, ***bériði**, ***bīridi**, beside inf. **beran**; O.Icel. **sitja**, OS. **sittian**, OHG. **sizzen**, OE. **sittan**, from an original form ***sedjonom**, *to sit*; and similarly O.Icel. **liggja**, OS. **liggian**, OHG. **liggen**, OE. **licgan**, *to lie down*.

This sound-law accounts for the difference in the stem-vowels of such pairs as OE. **feld** (OHG. **feld**), *field*: **gēfilde** (OHG. **gīfildi**), *a plain*; **feþer**, *feather*: **fiþere**, *wing*; **weder** (OHG. **wetar**), *weather*: **gewider** (OHG. **giwītiri**), *storm*; **heord** (OHG. **herta**), *herd*: **hierde** (OHG. **hirti**), *shepherd*; **helpan**, *to help*: **hīlpst**, **hīlpp** (OHG. **hīlfis**, **hīlfit**); **beran**, *to bear*: **bir(e)st**, **bir(e)þ** (OHG. **biris**, **birit**), and similarly in the second and third person singular of the present indicative of many other strong verbs; pp. **legen**, **seten**: inf. **licgan**, *to lie down*, **sittan**, *to sit*.

3. In unaccented syllables, except in the combination -er when not followed by an i in the next syllable, as OE. *fēt*, older *fōt*, from **fōtiz*, older **fōtes*, *feet*, cp. Lat. *pedes*, Gr. *πόδες*. Indg. e remained in unaccented syllables in the combination -er when not followed by an i in the next syllable, as acc. OS. *fader*, OHG. *fater*, OE. *fæder*, Gr. *πατέρα*, *father*; OE. *hwæper*, Gr. *πότερος*, *which of two*.

§ 42. i, followed originally by an *ǣ*, *ö*, or *ē* in the next syllable, became e when not protected by a nasal+consonant or an intervening i or j, as O.Icel. *verr*, OS. OHG. OE. *wer*, Lat. *vir*, from an original form **wiros*, *man*; OHG. OE. *nest*, Lat. *nīdus*, from an original form **nizdos*. In historic times, however, this law has a great number of exceptions owing to the separate languages having levelled out in various directions, as OE. *spec* beside *spic*, *bacon*; OHG. *lebara* beside OE. *lifer*, *liver*; OHG. *leccōn* beside OE. *liccian*, *to lick*; OHG. *lebēn* beside OE. *libban*, *to live*; OHG. *quec* beside OE. *cwic*, *quick*, *alive*.

§ 43. u, followed originally by an *ǣ*, *ö*, or *ē* in the next syllable, became o when not protected by a nasal+consonant or an intervening i or j, as OS. *dohter*, OHG. *tohter*, OE. *dohtor*, Gr. *θυγάτηρ*, *daughter*; O.Icel. *ok*, OHG. *joh*, OE. *geoc* (§ 110), Gr. *ζυγόν*, *yoke*; OHG. *got*, OS. OE. *god*, from an original form **ghutóm*, *god*; OHG. OE. *gold*, *gold*, beside OHG. *guldīn*, OE. *gylden*, *golden*; pp. OS. *giholpan*, OHG. *gihofan*, OE. *geholpen*, *helped*, beside pp. OS. *gibundan*, OHG. *gibuntan*, OE. *gebunden*, *bound*; pp. OS. *gibodan*, OHG. *gibotan*, OE. *geboden*, *offered*, beside pret. pl. OS. *budun*, OHG. *butum*, OE. *budon*, *we offered*. Every prim. Germanic o in accented syllables was of this origin. Cp. § 20.

This sound-law accounts for the difference in the stem-vowels of such pairs as OE. *cnotta*, *knot*: *cnyttan* from

***knuttjan**, *to tie*; **coss**, *a kiss*: **cyssan**, *to kiss*; **corn**, *corn*: **cyrnel**, *kernel*; **fox**: **fyxen**, *she-fox*; **god**: **gyden** (OHG. *gutin*), *goddess*; **hold**, *gracious*: **hyldo** (OHG. *huldi*), *grace, favour*; pret. **bohte**, **worhte**: inf. **bycgan**, *to buy*, **wyrcan**, *to work*.

u became ū under the same conditions as those by which a and i became ā and ī, as pret. third pers. singular Goth. **þūhta**, OS. **thūhta**, OHG. **dūhta**, OE. **þūhte**, beside inf. Goth. **þugkjan**, OS. **thunkian**, OHG. **dunken**, OE. **þyncan**, *to seem*; Goth. **ūhtwō**, OS. OHG. **ūhta**, OE. **ūhte**, *daybreak, dawn*; OHG. **fūhti**, OE. **fūht**, *damp*.

§ 44. The diphthong **eu** became **iu** when the next syllable originally contained an i, ī, or j, cp. § 41 (2), but remained **eu** when the next syllable originally contained an ā, ō, or ē. The **iu** remained in OS. and OHG., but became **jū** (ȳ by i-umlaut) in O.Icel., and **īo**, (īe by i-umlaut) in OE., as Goth. **liuhtjan**, OS. **liuhtian**, OHG. **liuhten**, OE. **liehtan**, *to give light*: OE. **lēoht**, *a light*; O.Icel. **dýpt**, OS. **diupi**, OHG. **tiufī**, OE. **diepe**, *depth*: OE. **dēop**, *deep*; OS. **liudi**, OHG. **liuti**, OE. **liode**, *people*; OS. **kiusid**, OHG. **kiusit**, O.Icel. **kýs(s)**, OE. **cīesþ**, *he chooses*: OE. **cēosan**, *to choose*. See § 138.

§ 45. From what has been said in §§ 40-4, it will be seen that the prim. Germanic vowel-system had assumed the following shape before the Germanic parent language became differentiated into the various separate languages:—

Short vowels	a, e, i, o, u
Long „	ā, æ, ē, ī, ō, ū
Diphthongs	ai, au, eu, iu

The following table contains the normal development of the above vowel-system in Goth. O.Icel. OS. OHG. and OE. stem-syllables:—

P. Germ.	Goth.	O.Icel.	OS.	OHG.	OE.
a	a	a	a	a	æ
e	i	e	e	e	e
i	i	i	i	i	i
o	u	o	o	o	o
u	u	u	u	u	u
ā	ā	ā	ā	ā	ō
æ	ē	ā	ā	ā	æ
ē	ē	ē	ē	ia, (ie)	ē
ī	ei	ī	ī	ī	ī
ō	ō	ō	ō	uo	ō
ū	ū	ū	ū	ū	ū
ai	ái	ei	ē	ei	ā
au	áu	au	ō	ou	ēa
eu	iu	jō	eo, (io)	eo, (io)	ēo
iu	iu	jū	iu	iu	īo

NOTE.—The table does not include the sound-changes which were caused by umlaut, the influence of neighbouring consonants, &c. For details of this kind the student should consult the grammars of the separate languages. But as we shall have occasion to make use of many Gothic, OS. and OHG.

forms in this grammar, the following points should be noted here :—

1. Goth. **i** and **u** were broken to **ai** (= short open **e**) and **au** (= short open **o**) before **r**, **h**, and **hr**, as **baíran**, OE. **beran**, *to bear*; **saihran**, OHG. **sehan**, *to see*; **baíriþ**, OHG. **birit**, *he bears*; **saihrþ**, OHG. **sihit**, *he sees*; pp. **baúrans**, OE. **boren**, *borne*; **daúhtar**, OE. **dohtor**, *daughter*; **waúrms**, OHG. **wurm**, *serpent, worm*; **sauhts**, OHG. **suht**, *sickness*. Gothic **ei** was a monophthong and was pronounced like the **i** in the other Germanic languages. Germanic **ai** and **au** remained in Gothic, but they are generally written **ái** and **áu** in order to distinguish them from the short vowels **ai** and **au**.

2. **a** was the only vowel which underwent i-umlaut in OS. and OHG., as sing. **gast**, pl. **gesti** = Goth. **gasteis**, *guests*; OS. **sendian**, OHG. **senten** = Goth. **sandjan**, *to send*. When it is necessary for phonological reasons to distinguish between this **e** and Germanic **e**, the latter is written **ě** in this book, as **běran**, *to bear*.

3. Prim. Germanic **ai** became **ē** in OHG. before **r**, **w**, and old **h**, as **ēr**, *before* = Goth. **áir**, *soon*; **ēht** = Goth. **áihts**, *possession*; gen. **snēwes**, Goth. nom. **snáiws**, *snow*.

4. Prim. Germanic **au** became **ō** in OHG. before the consonants **d**, **t**, **z**, **s**, **n**, **r**, **l**, and old **h**, as **tōd** = Goth. **dáupus**, *death*; **kōs** = Goth. **káus**, *he chose*; **hōh** = Goth. **háuhs**, *high*.

CHAPTER IV

THE OLD ENGLISH DEVELOPMENT OF THE PRIM. GERMANIC VOWELS OF ACCENTED SYLLABLES

§ 46. Before entering upon the history of the separate Germanic vowels in OE. it will be well to state and illustrate here several phenomena which concern the OE. vowels in general.

I. UMLAUT.

§ 47. Umlaut is of two kinds: Palatal and Guttural. Palatal umlaut, generally called i-umlaut, is the modification

(palatalization) of an accented vowel through the influence of an *ī* or *j* which originally stood in the following syllable. This process took place in prehistoric OE. and the *ī* or *j* had for the most part already disappeared in the oldest OE. records. The *i*, which remained, mostly became *e* at an early period (§ 215, Note), so that for the proper understanding of the forms which underwent *i*-umlaut it is necessary to compare them with the corresponding forms of some other Germanic language, especially with the Gothic. The simple vowels and diphthongs which underwent *i*-umlaut in OE. are: *a(o)*, *æ*, *o*, *u*; *ā*, *ō*, *ū*; *ea*, *io*; *ēa* and *īo*.

a(o) > *e* (but *æ* in the oldest period), as *benc* from **baŋkiz*, *bench*; *ende*, Goth. *andeis*, *end*; *lengra*, OHG. *lengiro*, *longer*; *lengþ(u)* from **laŋgiþu*, *length*; *sendan*, Goth. *sandjan*, *to send* (§ 60).

æ > *e*, as *bedd*, Goth. *badi*, *bed*; *bet(e)ra*, Goth. *batiza*, *better*; *hebban*, Goth. *hafjan*, *to raise*; *here*, Goth. *harjis*, *army*; *lecgan*, Goth. *lagjan*, *to lay* (§ 55).

o > *e* (older *œ*), as *dat. dehter* from **dohtri*, beside nom. *dohtor*, *daughter*; *ele*, Lat. *oleum*, *oil*; *exen*, *oxen*, beside *oxa*, *ox* (§ 107).

u > *y*, as *bycgan*, Goth. *bugjan*, *to buy*; *cyning*, OHG. *kuning*, *king*; *cynn*, Goth. *kuni*, *race*, *generation*; *gylden*, OHG. *guldin*, *golden*; *þyncan*, Goth. *þugkjan*, *to seem* (§ 112).

ā > *æ*, as *dāelan*, Goth. *dāiljan*, *to divide*; *ānig*, *any*; *hælan*, Goth. *hāiljan*, *to heal*; *hæþ*, Goth. *háiþi*, *heath* (§ 134); *lāwan*, Goth. *lēwjan*, *to betray* (§ 120).

ō > *ē* (older *œ*), as *bēc* from **bōkiz*, *books*; *dēman*, Goth. *dōmjan*, *to judge*; *fēt*, OHG. *fuozzi*, *feet*; *sēcan*, Goth. *sōkjan*, *to seek* (§ 129). *wēnan*, Goth. *wēnjan*, *to hope*; *cwēn* from **kwōni*-, older **kwāniz*, Goth. *qēns*, *queen*, *wife* (§ 122). *ēhtan* from **ōhtjan*, *to persecute*; *fēhþ*, *he seizes*, beside inf. *fōn* (§ 118). *ēst* from **ōsti*-, older

*anstiz, Goth. ansts, *favour*; tēþ, prim. Germanic *tanþiz, *teeth* (§ 62).

ū > ŷ, as mŷs from *mūsiz, *mice*; brŷcst from *brūkis, *thou enjoyest*, brŷcþ from *brūkiþ, *he enjoys*, beside inf. brūcan (§ 132). cŷ from *kū-iz, *cows* (§ 130). cŷpan from *kūþjan, older *kunþjan, *to make known*; dŷstig, *dusty* (§ 114).

ea > ie (later i, y), as fiellan from *fealljan, older *falljan, *to fell*; ieldra, Goth. alpiza, older (§ 65). ierfe, Goth. arbi, *inheritance*; iermþ(u), OHG. armida, *poverty* (§ 67). scieppan, Goth. skapjan, *to create* (§ 73). hliehhan, Goth. hlahjan, *to laugh*; wiexþ, OHG. wahsit, *it grows* (§ 69).

io > ie (later i, y), as hierde, OHG. hirti, *shepherd*; ierre, OHG. irri, *angry*; siehst, OHG. sihis, *thou seest*; siehþ, OHG. sihit, *he sees*; wiersa, OHG. wirsiro, *worse* (§ 99).

ēa > ie (later ī, ŷ), as geliefan, Goth. galáubjan, *to believe*; hiehsta, Goth. háuhista, *highest*; hīeran, Goth. háusjan, *to hear* (§ 136). cīese, Lat. cāseus, *cheese*; nīehsta from *nēahista, *nearest* (§ 123). stīele, Germanic stem-form staxlja-, *steel* (§ 71). wīelisc, prim. Germanic walxi-skaz, *foreign* (§ 64, Note 1).

īo > ie (later ī, ŷ), as cīesþ from *kīosiþ, older *kīusiþ, *he chooses*; tiehþ from *tīohiþ, *he draws*; liehtan, Goth. liuhtjan, *to give light* (§ 138). liehtan from līohtjan, older *līxtjan, *to lighten, make easier*; liehþ from *līohiþ, OHG. līhit, *he lends* (§ 127). friend, prim. Germanic *frijōndiz, *friends* (§ 104).

§ 48. Guttural umlaut is the modification of an accented vowel (a, e, i) through the influence of a primitive OE. guttural vowel (u, ō, a) in the next syllable, whereby a guttural glide was developed after the vowels a, e, i, which then combined with them to form the diphthongs ea, eo, io. As a rule umlaut only took place before a single consonant.